Jaffna at night. Nero usually spoke on the wireless transmitter starting with '910 to 91' and then connected. But after that all communication would be in alphanumeric codes, which Vijayan had no clue how to read. What intrigued Vijayan about Sivarasan and the two human bombs was that they always kept their things in black duffel bags and carried them around whenever they would go out. One day he asked Sivarasan about it. Instead of answering his direct question, Sivarasan gave him Rs 10,000 in support of his kitchen.[4]

But more surprises awaited Vijayan. Sivarasan had asked him and Nero to dig up a pit in the kitchen, where he hid the wireless set and a gun. On the morning of 21 May, Sivarasan asked Nero to send a message to Jaffna. Vijayan said he distinctly remembered that Nero appeared nervous when sending the message—and that Sivarasan did not like it. He suddenly got Dhanu there and asked Nero to look at her. Dhanu did not know what the message was about but could guess. She tried to boost Nero's morale and asked him to take pride in sending out that message. Sivarasan asked the girls to have lunch and be ready by noon. He left after that.[5]

The mastermind came back half an hour later wearing a kurta pyjama with a camera in hand. Shubha and Dhanu came out of their room, ready. Shubha was wearing a sari. Usually, Vijayan's wife would help Shubha wear a sari, but that day she managed it on her own. Dhanu was dressed in an orange kurta with a green dupatta. She was also wearing spectacles and had put on make-up. By that time, Selvaluxmi had appeared on the scene and asked Shubha why she hadn't called her before wearing the sari. Sivarasan handed the camera to Vijayan.[6]

A photo session started after that. Vijayan clicked about ten photographs of Sivarasan, Dhanu and Shubha—some solo, some in a group and some in pairs. Sivarasan had asked Nero to get an autorickshaw and wait near the bus stand. Neither Vijayan nor Selvaluxmi found that unusual. The idea was to keep the driver from identifying the house later.

With Vijayan and his father-in-law Bhaskaran, no coaxing was required and no admonishment was necessary. Both spoke to the SIT as if getting a weight off their chests.